



SMOOTH Quiet luxury has extended to menswear with brands like Zegna, which has actor Mads Mikkelsen as an ambassador



No wonder then that today Hollywood A-listers like Gwyneth Paltrow, David Beckham, Kylie Jenner, and the Olsen sisters have all jumped aboard, endorsing a style defined by monochrome outfits, tailored pants, linen shirts, and neutral colour palettes.

Interestingly, much of the momentum behind this resurgence can be attributed to GenZ, a generation that grew up with an abundance of information. Overwhelmed by the excessive displays of wealth and often inauthentic lifestyles portrayed on social media, GenZ yearns for authenticity and genuine connections. Economic challenges, global crises, and a keen sense of responsibility have made it more environmentally conscious and critical of conspicuous consumption.

The pandemic and the financial insecurity that came with it also meant that flaunting expensive logos was considered insensitive. Brands, too, were wary of being associated with excessive wealth. Plus, pop culture influence came into play as mentioned earlier with shows like *Succession*.

It is a resurgent fashion movement that emphasises investment in high-quality, minimalist pieces

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Beyond aesthetics, quiet luxury reflects a broader shift towards sustainable and ethical practices. The circular economy, where products are designed for longevity and can be reused, recycled, or upcycled, aligns seamlessly with quiet luxury. As more customers demand transparency and responsible production, brands are recognising the value of investing in sustainable materials and eco-friendly processes. It is a business imperative.

According to a recent report by industry body Global Fashion Agenda, brands focussing on sustainability are likely to outperform their competitors in the coming decade. Thus, it signifies a deeper commitment to ethical production, waste reduction, and a future where fashion is in sync with the environment. In a sense, brands embracing quiet luxury are not just making a style statement but championing a movement towards a sustainable and circular future in retail. **BT**

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